

gághiri

emekthian's Gágìrhi Language

Info

This file contains a text dump of

<https://www.angelfire.com/ultra/fnuh/conlangs/kokiri.html> which has been proofread and edited by [Austin Springer](#). The information provided here is limited, but is all the publicly available documentation for this conlang.

Introduction

Gágìrhi is the language of the Kokiri from The Legend of Zelda: Ocarina of Time (the Kokiri's name for themselves is also *Gágìrhi* -- it has been Anglicized (and Hylianized 😊) into "kokiri"). The Kokiri are a race of childlike people who live in the Kokiri forest in the east of Hyrule (if you don't know what I'm talking about, you haven't played Ocarina of Time. If you haven't played Ocarina of Time, for the love of Din, Nayru and Farore *play it!* It's one of the best video games ever made!).

Some notable features of Gágìrhi are:

- **Gágìrhi** makes an aspirated/unaspirated distinction, and has implosives
- The language doesn't mark tense on the verb, but does mark aspect
- In shouted Gágìrhi, or in other situations where the volume level is unclear, the speaker says a drawn out "a" before speaking to indicate the "base level" of volume. This is known as a **jjíbag**.
- I realize that 4 list items isn't much, but I'm still working on Gágìrhi!

Phonology

Consonants

	Labial	Alveolar	Palatal	Uvular
Stops	<b p bb> /p p ^h b/	<d t> /d t/	<j c jj> /c c ^h ʃ/	<g gg> /q ɢ/
Fricatives	<f v> /f v/	<s z> /s z/	<sh zh> /ʃ ʒ/	<kh gh> /χ ʁ/

	Labial	Alveolar	Palatal	Uvular
Approximants		<r> /ɹ/	<y> /j/	<rh> /ʀ/

The consonants <bb>, <jj>, and <gg> are actually implosives. , <j> and <g> are unaspirated unvoiced plosives, and <p> and <c> are the aspirated counterparts. There is no aspirated velar plosive, nor is there a alveolar implosive.

r is actually an alveolar approximant, like the "r" in American English (IPA /ɹ/). rh is an uvular trill, like in French.

Vowels

Vowels in Gágĩrhi have a volume dimension. In other words, /a/ can be 2 different vowels, depending on how loud or soft it is spoken. The volume levels are numbered from 1 (low) to 5 (high).

There are three base vowels: a /a/, i /i/, and u /u/. Note that the u is unrounded. The vowel by itself is at level 3 volume. An acute accent raises it one level (to 4) and an umlaut raises it two levels (to 5). So a-3, á-4, ä-5.

Similarly, a grave will lower the volume by one level, and a circumflex will lower the volume by two levels. u-3, ù-2, û-1. **Some vowel and volume combinations don't exist; there is no à, î or ú.**

Alternate notation

For IPA notation, Austin recommends using tone markings to represent volume of the segment.

Volume can also be noted by adding the volume number of a syllable (in standard Indoarabic numerals) at the start of each syllable, though this is recommended only where neither IPA tone nor diacritics are viable.

Verbs

All verbs in Gágĩrhi have a CVC particle directly after them: **dájju ggibb**. The CVC particle indicates aspect, person, and mood. The first consonant indicates aspect, the vowel indicates person, and the last consonant indicates mood. Gágĩrhi doesn't express tense on the verb; you have to use a word like "tomorrow."

Aspect

Gágírhi uses the following aspects:

- **Perfective**: indicating that the action is complete, or that it will be complete (even if the action hasn't taken place yet).
- **Imperfective**: The opposite of the perfective, indicating that the action isn't completed.
- **Inchoative**: Indicates that the action is beginning, or will begin, or has begun.
- **Cessative**: The inchoative's opposite, indicating that the action has stopped.
- **Habitual**: Indicates that the action takes place multiple times.
- **Progressive**: Indicates that the action is ongoing.

Each aspect is indicated by a different consonant in the initial place in the particle:

Perfective	Imperfective	Inchoative	Habitual	Progressive	Cessative
c--	t--	gg--	b--	jj--	p--

For example, **pakìvu**, "to dance", in the perfect aspect would be **pakìvu c--**, and in the habitual aspect would be **pakìvu b--**

Person

Person is marked on Gágírhi verbs by the vowel in the CVC particle. To understand how this process works, you need to know about the Gágírhi pronouns.

Gágírhi uses a system of variables that can be assigned to nouns instead of pronouns. To assign a variable to a noun, you add the particle **bb-gh** right before the noun. The blank space can be either **a**, **i**, **u**, or **ü**. These four vowels serve as the variables. There is also a general pronoun word, **p-s**. The blank space can be one of the four variable vowels.

For example, take the noun **zhaggiv**. To assign it to the **ü** variable, you would say **bbügh zhaggiv**. You could then refer to it as a noun by saying **püs**, or as the person of a verb by saying **pakìvu -ü-**.

Whenever the subject of a verb isn't a pronoun, but a noun, use **í** as the vowel: **zhaggiv pakìmu -í-**. Note that you could also say **bbagh zhaggiv pakìmu -a-**

Noun	Marked a	Marked i	Marked u	Marked ü
-í-	-a-	-i-	-u-	-ü-

Mood

Gágírhi has several moods:

- **Indicative**: the default mood

- **Subjunctive:** used for desired states, or for statements that may or may not be true, or for hypotheticals. Often the equivalent of English "may" or "might"
- **Conditional:** used in if:then statements, often the equivalent of English "would"
- **Negative:** used to indicate that the statement is untrue.

Here are the endings for each mood:

Indicative	Subjunctive	Conditional	Negative
∅ (null)	bb	z	gh

Addition

The following section is added by Austin for ease of use, it compiles the information above into an easy-to-use table.

Verbal Particle Template Table

The table below is a template for all 24 verbal endings before personal inflection is applied. The <-> in these templates should be replaced with the appropriate vowel for the agent or subject of the verb.

	PerFectiVe	ImPerFectiVe	INCHoative	HABitual	PRoGressive	C
INDicative	c-	t-	gg-	b-	jj-	
SubJunctiVe	c-bb	t-bb	gg-bb	b-bb	jj-bb	
CoNDitional	c-z	t-z	gg-z	b-z	jj-z	
NEGative	c-gh	t-gh	gg-gh	b-gh	jj-gh	

End addition

This is the end of the additional section.

Other Verb Markings

Gágirhi marks several other things on the verb.

Definiteness

Definiteness ("the dog" is definite, "a dog" is indefinite) is marked on the verb in Gágirhi. The default form is indefinite. To indicate definiteness, you add the vowel -ī to the verb if it ends in a consonant: **shívâd** "a (noun) works", **shívâdī** "the (noun) works". If the verb ends in a vowel, that vowel is raised to the highest volume: **jjüsá** → **jjüs*ä****; **pakívu** → **pakívü**.

Nouns

Nouns are inflected by number (singular, dual and plural) and case (nominative, accusative, dative, possessive).

Case

- **Nominative**: The subject of a sentence, and the unmarked form of a noun
- **Accusative**: Used for the direct object, and for some prepositions. A noun in the accusative is preceded by the direct object particle **fí**.
- **Dative**: Used for the indirect object, and for the object of most prepositions. A noun in the dative is preceded by the indirect object particle **âjj**.
- **Possessive**: Used to express possession, like English 's. A noun in the possessive has the suffix **-zhi**

Nominative	Accusative	Dative	Possessive
∅ (null)	fí *	âjj *	*-zhi

Number

The three numbers in Gágírhi are singular, dual and plural. The singular is the default form of a noun, and is used to express that there is only one of a noun. The plural is used to express that there are more than one of a noun. Both of these are used similarly to the way they are used in English. The dual is used when talking about a pair of things (like two lips, two shoes). "Two shoes" is shoes-DUAL.

Note that the dual is not used when referring to two things that aren't a logical pair; "two bricks" that have nothing to do with each other are "two brick-PLURAL"

Plural

The plural is formed by adding the suffix **-ggâ**. The dual is formed by adding the suffix **-jjí**.

	Nominative	Accusative	Dative	Possessive
Singular	*	fí *	âjj *	*-zhi
Dual	*-jjí	fí *-jjí	âjj *-jjí	*-zhijjí
Plural	*-ggâ	fí *-ggâ	âjj *-ggâ	*-zhiggâ

Sample Sentences

Here are some sample sentences in Gágírhi:

The House is Collapsing

bbagh dâfibbû ggizhî jja

ASSIGN.A house collapses DEFINITE PROGRESSIVE-A.VARIABLE-INDICATIVE

The house is collapsing.

<i>bbagh</i>	<i>dâfibbû</i>	<i>ggizhî</i>	<i>jja</i>
ᐆᐁᐃ	ᐃᐃᐃ.ᐆᐆᐃ.ᐆᐁᐃ	ᐆᐁᐆ.ᐆᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐃ
ASSIGN.A	house	collapse-DEF	PRG-INDIC-A

"The house is collapsing."

Emekthian's Mom Isn't Eating a Tree

This sample sentence was posted on the Vinculum on 2004-Mar-15.

emekthian-zhi shâkhî tabbû pigh fî pîkhabbû
emekthian-POSES mother eat-PROG-NEGATIVE tree
Emekthian's mom isn't eating a tree.

<i>apîgtiägg-zhi</i>	<i>shâkhi</i>	<i>tabbû</i>	<i>jjîgh</i>	<i>fî</i>	<i>pîkhabbû</i>
ᐆᐃᐃ.ᐆᐆᐆᐆᐆ.ᐆᐆᐆ.ᐆᐆᐆᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐃ.ᐆᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐃ.ᐆᐁᐃ	ᐆᐆᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐆ.ᐆᐆᐃ.ᐆᐁᐃ
emekthian-POSS	mother	eat	PRG-NOM-NEG	DIROBJ	tree
emekthian's	mother	eat	not doing		tree

"Emekthian's mother isn't eating a tree."

Rhüna Throws a Ball to Jjaz

bbagh rhünâ, bbigh jjaz, cîsábbu ta fî jjashí âjj pis
Rhünâ="A" VARIABLE, Jjaz="I" VARIABLE, throw IMPERFECTIVE-"A"-INDICATIVE
ball-INDEFINATE-ACC "I" VARIABLE-DATIVE
Rhünâ throws a ball to Jjaz

<i>bbhag</i>	<i>rhüggâ</i>	<i>bbigh</i>	<i>jjaz</i>	<i>cîsábbu</i>	<i>ta</i>	<i>fî</i>	<i>jjashí</i>
ᐆᐁᐃ	ᐆᐆᐆ.ᐆᐆᐃ	ᐆᐁᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐆᐆ.ᐆᐃᐃ.ᐆᐃᐃ.ᐆᐁᐃ	ᐆᐆᐃ	ᐆᐆᐆ	ᐆᐆᐃ.ᐆᐆᐆ
person-A	Rhügga	person-I	Jjaz	throw	IPFV-CL.A-INDIC	ACC	ball
A	Rhüna	I	Jjaz	throw	s		a ball

âjj *pis*
ᐆᐆᐆ ᐆᐆᐆᐆᐆ
DAT person-I
to pis

"Rhüna to Jjaz throws a ball."

Added information

The following section is added by Austin to compile the words presented in this document for easy reference.

Lexicon

Words

The words here are listed in order of their appearance within the above text.

- **gághĩri** / ɫga.ɫbi.ɫi / 1. kokiri
- **jjĩbag** / ɫji.ɫbag / 1. volume modulation, setting neutral volume
- **dájju** / ɫda.ɫɟu / 1. (verb) ???
- **pakivu** / ɫpha.ɫki.ɫvu / 1. to dance
- **zhaggiv** / ɫʒa.ɫɪv / 1. (noun) ???
- **pas** / ɫphas / 1. a-person pronoun
- **pis** / ɫphis / 1. i-person pronoun
- **pus** / ɫphus / 1. u-person pronoun
- **püs** / ɫphus / 1. ü-person pronoun
- **shívâd** / ɫʃi.ɫvad / 1. to work
- **jjüśá** / ɫɟu.ɫsa / 1. ???
- **dâfibbû** / ɫda.ɫfi.ɫbu / 1. house
- **ggizhĩ** / ɫbi.ɫʒi / 1. to collapse
- **shăkhi** / ɫʃa.ɫxi / 1. mother
- **tabbü** / ɫta.ɫbu / 1. eat
- **pìkhabbû** / ɫpi.ɫxa.ɫbu / 1. tree
- **cīsábbu** / ɫchi.ɫsa.ɫbu / 1. throw
- **jjashí** / ɫʃa.ɫʃi / 1. ball

Particles

Variable Assigners

- **bbagh** / ɫbaɤ / 1. variable assignment "a" follows
- **bbigh** / ɫbiɤ / 1. variable assignment "i" follows
- **bbugh** / ɫbuɤ / 1. variable assignment "u" follows
- **bbügh** / ɫbuɤ / 1. variable assignment "ü" follows

Object Markers

- **fī** / ʃi / 1. direct object follows
- **âjj** / Jaʃ / 1. indirect object follows
- **-zhi** / ʒi / 1. possessive, genitive possessor
- **-ggâ** / ʒa / 1. plural noun
- **-jjí** / ʃi / 1. dual noun; logical dual, relational dual

Perfective

- **ca** / ʃa / 1. perfective a-marked indicative verb
- **ci** / ʃi / 1. perfective i-marked indicative verb
- **cí** / ʃi / 1. perfective noun-marked indicative verb
- **cu** / ʃu / 1. perfective u-marked indicative verb
- **cü** / ʃu / 1. perfective ü-marked indicative verb
- **cabb** / ʃab / 1. perfective a-marked subjunctive verb
- **cibb** / ʃib / 1. perfective i-marked subjunctive verb
- **cíbb** / ʃib / 1. perfective noun-marked subjunctive verb
- **cubb** / ʃub / 1. perfective u-marked subjunctive verb
- **cübb** / ʃub / 1. perfective ü-marked subjunctive verb
- **caz** / ʃaz / 1. perfective a-marked conditional verb
- **ciz** / ʃiz / 1. perfective i-marked conditional verb
- **cíz** / ʃiz / 1. perfective noun-marked conditional verb
- **cuz** / ʃuz / 1. perfective u-marked conditional verb
- **cüz** / ʃuz / 1. perfective ü-marked conditional verb
- **cagh** / ʃab / 1. perfective a-marked negative verb
- **cigh** / ʃib / 1. perfective i-marked negative verb
- **cígh** / ʃib / 1. perfective noun-marked negative verb
- **cugh** / ʃub / 1. perfective u-marked negative verb
- **cügh** / ʃub / 1. perfective ü-marked negative verb

Imperfective

- **ta** / ʃa / 1. imperfective a-marked indicative verb
- **ti** / ʃi / 1. imperfective i-marked indicative verb
- **tí** / ʃi / 1. imperfective noun-marked indicative verb
- **tu** / ʃu / 1. imperfective u-marked indicative verb
- **tü** / ʃu / 1. imperfective ü-marked indicative verb
- **tabb** / ʃab / 1. imperfective a-marked subjunctive verb

- **tibb** / ʔtiβ / 1. imperfective i-marked subjunctive verb
- **tíbb** / ʔtiβ / 1. imperfective noun-marked subjunctive verb
- **tubb** / ʔtuβ / 1. imperfective u-marked subjunctive verb
- **tübb** / ʔtuβ / 1. imperfective ü-marked subjunctive verb
- **taz** / ʔtaz / 1. imperfective a-marked conditional verb
- **tiz** / ʔtiz / 1. imperfective i-marked conditional verb
- **tíz** / ʔtiz / 1. imperfective noun-marked conditional verb
- **tuz** / ʔtuz / 1. imperfective u-marked conditional verb
- **tüz** / ʔtuz / 1. imperfective ü-marked conditional verb
- **tagh** / ʔtaɁ / 1. imperfective a-marked negative verb
- **tigh** / ʔtiɁ / 1. imperfective i-marked negative verb
- **tígh** / ʔtiɁ / 1. imperfective noun-marked negative verb
- **tugh** / ʔtuɁ / 1. imperfective u-marked negative verb
- **tügh** / ʔtuɁ / 1. imperfective ü-marked negative verb

Inchoative

- **gga** / ʔga / 1. inchoative a-marked indicative verb
- **ggi** / ʔgi / 1. inchoative i-marked indicative verb
- **ggí** / ʔgi / 1. inchoative noun-marked indicative verb
- **ggu** / ʔgu / 1. inchoative u-marked indicative verb
- **ggü** / ʔgu / 1. inchoative ü-marked indicative verb
- **ggabb** / ʔgab / 1. inchoative a-marked subjunctive verb
- **ggibb** / ʔgiβ / 1. inchoative i-marked subjunctive verb
- **ggíbb** / ʔgiβ / 1. inchoative noun-marked subjunctive verb
- **ggubb** / ʔguβ / 1. inchoative u-marked subjunctive verb
- **ggübb** / ʔguβ / 1. inchoative ü-marked subjunctive verb
- **ggaz** / ʔgaz / 1. inchoative a-marked conditional verb
- **ggiz** / ʔgiz / 1. inchoative i-marked conditional verb
- **ggíz** / ʔgiz / 1. inchoative noun-marked conditional verb
- **gguz** / ʔguz / 1. inchoative u-marked conditional verb
- **ggüz** / ʔguz / 1. inchoative ü-marked conditional verb
- **ggagh** / ʔgaɁ / 1. inchoative a-marked negative verb
- **ggigh** / ʔgiɁ / 1. inchoative i-marked negative verb
- **ggígh** / ʔgiɁ / 1. inchoative noun-marked negative verb
- **ggugh** / ʔguɁ / 1. inchoative u-marked negative verb
- **ggügh** / ʔguɁ / 1. inchoative ü-marked negative verb

Habitual

- **ba** / ɬpa / 1. habitual a-marked indicative verb
- **bi** / ɬpi / 1. habitual i-marked indicative verb
- **bí** / ɬpi / 1. habitual noun-marked indicative verb
- **bu** / ɬpu / 1. habitual u-marked indicative verb
- **bü** / ɬpu / 1. habitual ü-marked indicative verb
- **babb** / ɬpaɓ / 1. habitual a-marked subjunctive verb
- **bibb** / ɬpiɓ / 1. habitual i-marked subjunctive verb
- **bíbb** / ɬpiɓ / 1. habitual noun-marked subjunctive verb
- **bubb** / ɬpuɓ / 1. habitual u-marked subjunctive verb
- **bübb** / ɬpuɓ / 1. habitual ü-marked subjunctive verb
- **baz** / ɬpaz / 1. habitual a-marked conditional verb
- **biz** / ɬpiz / 1. habitual i-marked conditional verb
- **bíz** / ɬpiz / 1. habitual noun-marked conditional verb
- **buz** / ɬpuz / 1. habitual u-marked conditional verb
- **büz** / ɬpuz / 1. habitual ü-marked conditional verb
- **bagh** / ɬpaɣ / 1. habitual a-marked negative verb
- **bigh** / ɬpiɣ / 1. habitual i-marked negative verb
- **bígh** / ɬpiɣ / 1. habitual noun-marked negative verb
- **bugh** / ɬpuɣ / 1. habitual u-marked negative verb
- **bügh** / ɬpuɣ / 1. habitual ü-marked negative verb

Progressive

- **jja** / ɬʃa / 1. progressive a-marked indicative verb
- **jji** / ɬʃi / 1. progressive i-marked indicative verb
- **jjí** / ɬʃi / 1. progressive noun-marked indicative verb
- **jju** / ɬʃu / 1. progressive u-marked indicative verb
- **jjü** / ɬʃu / 1. progressive ü-marked indicative verb
- **jjabb** / ɬʃaɓ / 1. progressive a-marked subjunctive verb
- **jjibb** / ɬʃiɓ / 1. progressive i-marked subjunctive verb
- **jjíbb** / ɬʃiɓ / 1. progressive noun-marked subjunctive verb
- **jjubb** / ɬʃuɓ / 1. progressive u-marked subjunctive verb
- **jjübb** / ɬʃuɓ / 1. progressive ü-marked subjunctive verb
- **jjaz** / ɬʃaz / 1. progressive a-marked conditional verb
- **jjiz** / ɬʃiz / 1. progressive i-marked conditional verb
- **jjíz** / ɬʃiz / 1. progressive noun-marked conditional verb
- **jjuz** / ɬʃuz / 1. progressive u-marked conditional verb

- **jjüz** / ʃʒuz / 1. progressive ü-marked conditional verb
- **jjagh** / ʃʒaɸ / 1. progressive a-marked negative verb
- **jjigh** / ʃʒiɸ / 1. progressive i-marked negative verb
- **jjígh** / ʃʒiɸ / 1. progressive noun-marked negative verb
- **jjugh** / ʃʒuɸ / 1. progressive u-marked negative verb
- **jjügh** / ʃʒuɸ / 1. progressive ü-marked negative verb

Cessative

- **pa** / ʈpha / 1. cessative a-marked indicative verb
- **pi** / ʈphi / 1. cessative i-marked indicative verb
- **pí** / ʈphi / 1. cessative noun-marked indicative verb
- **pu** / ʈphu / 1. cessative u-marked indicative verb
- **pü** / ʈphu / 1. cessative ü-marked indicative verb
- **pabb** / ʈphaɸ / 1. cessative a-marked subjunctive verb
- **pibb** / ʈphiɸ / 1. cessative i-marked subjunctive verb
- **píbb** / ʈphiɸ / 1. cessative noun-marked subjunctive verb
- **pubb** / ʈphuɸ / 1. cessative u-marked subjunctive verb
- **pübb** / ʈphuɸ / 1. cessative ü-marked subjunctive verb
- **paz** / ʈphaz / 1. cessative a-marked conditional verb
- **piz** / ʈphiz / 1. cessative i-marked conditional verb
- **píz** / ʈphiz / 1. cessative noun-marked conditional verb
- **puz** / ʈphuz / 1. cessative u-marked conditional verb
- **püz** / ʈphuz / 1. cessative ü-marked conditional verb
- **pagh** / ʈphaɸ / 1. cessative a-marked negative verb
- **pigh** / ʈphiɸ / 1. cessative i-marked negative verb
- **pígh** / ʈphiɸ / 1. cessative noun-marked negative verb
- **pugh** / ʈphuɸ / 1. cessative u-marked negative verb
- **pügh** / ʈphuɸ / 1. cessative ü-marked negative verb